

It is a measure of Henry Kissinger's power that US policies advanced in areas where he exercised control. In other areas, progress remained fitful. Both the Vietnam negotiations and those on nuclear arms control—as well as Nixon's overtures to China—involved dominant Kissinger roles.

In Nixon's second term, Kissinger became secretary of state as well as NSC adviser. President Gerald Ford kept him as secretary of state but appointed a new national security adviser at the end of 1975.

Post-government

Kissinger left government in 1977 and opened an international consulting business. President Reagan appointed him to a policy review commission for Central America, and George W. Bush sought his advice on the Iraq War. Hillary Clinton also courted Kissinger when she was secretary of state under President Obama.

Kissinger continued to voice his opinions on world affairs right up until his death at the age of 100 in 2023. Some admired his strength and pragmatism; others accused him of war crimes for his role in various conflicts, including the Vietnam War, and his support of repressive regimes.



Elder statesman

Kissinger, a regular fixture on international lecture circuits, greets the audience at a ceremony at China's Hopkins-Nanjing Center, in 2007. Kissinger saw the rise of China, and the potential of economic cooperation, from an early point in his career.